

MSC 322, SPRING 2024-25

POST-TONAL THEORY

Professor: Tolga Yayalar
Class Hours: Monday 15:30-17:20 (room: 336)
Thursday 10:30-12:20 (room: 336)
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COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course is dedicated to analyzing the post-tonal repertoire of the 20th century. We will get familiar with some of the theoretical tools that are necessary to analyze this repertoire. Over the semester, we will look intensively into the music of Stravinsky, Bartok, Berg, Webern, Schoenberg, Debussy etc... However, we will also follow up on how early 20th-century techniques influenced post-war composers such as Boulez, Nono, Stockhausen, Ligeti, Lutosławski, Carter, Ferneyhough, Grisey, Murail etc.

COURSE STRUCTURE

The course is built around three big units with a smaller prelude and an epilogue. First, we will witness how tonality dissolved and chromaticism became systematic. In the first unit, we will build a theoretical framework - set-class theory- which we will use for the entire semester. We will concentrate on pre-serial atonal works of the 2nd Viennese School. The second unit will be entirely on twelve-tone music. First, we will study the basics of it, and then we will look at each composer and study their personal approaches to the technique. We'll finish the second unit with post-serial works in the century's second half. The third unit will be about alternative pitch organization methods that are developed in the aftermath of the dissolution of tonal language. We are going to look at symmetrical structures and pitch centricity. Finally, we'll finish with more recent developments such as spectralism and non-functional tonality etc...

This is a dynamic syllabus. This syllabus lets you access all the books, scores, and articles. Let me know if a link does not work.

REQUIRED MATERIALS

Joseph Straus, Introduction to Post-Tonal Theory 4th edition. (MT40 .S96 2005) - [link](#)

SUGGESTED MATERIALS

Miguel A. Roig-Francoli, Understanding Post-Tonal Music (MT90 .R65 2008) - [link](#)

Miguel A. Roig-Francoli, Anthology of Post-Tonal Music - [link](#)

Kent Williams, Theories and Analyses of 20th Century Music - [link](#)

Allen Forte, The Structure of Atonal Music (ML3811 .F67 1977) - [link](#)

These are all available on both dropbox. We will occasionally use them. You may also want to refer to them to strengthen your theoretical understanding of the topics in question. Forte is the main text for the set theory. It is rather more difficult than the rest. Roig-Francoli and Williams are more easily accessible and abundant with examples. If you find a certain topic too hard to comprehend in Straus, I suggest you check one of these books. They may occasionally have a more accessible explanation. You can also download Roig-Francoli's anthology. Some of the pieces we will analyze can be found in this anthology.

GRADING

3 Compositional Assignments 24% (8 each)
Homework 20% (2 points each x10)
Midterm Exam 12%
3 Presentations 9% (3 each)
Final analytic paper 20%
Attendance 15%

Weekly preparation

This is a high-intensity theory/analysis/composition course requiring at least 6 hours of weekly preparation, excluding projects and quiz preparations. We will strictly follow Straus and devote approximately one meeting per chapter in the first unit. For 12-tone and tone centricity, this will be expanded considerably. Before each class, you are expected to read the chapter and do the homework. These homework sheets are on the moodle site and they won't be handed out in the class. You need to turn in your exercise assignments on the due date. They are always due by the course hour. Late assignments are not accepted in this course and will result in an automatic 0.

You must familiarize yourself with the piece, make your own analysis, and read and understand Straus' analysis. There will also be additional readings. You are also expected to read them carefully and be prepared to discuss your reaction. There's an extensive bibliography at the end of the syllabus. You may use any of these sources when analyzing the pieces. These analysis meetings will be centered around group discussions of the pieces rather than lecturing. So please be prepared for this.

Grading policy for homework

The weekly assignments will be graded on a 3-point system, as explained below.

0 = The assignment is either not been handed in at all or handed in too late.

1 = The Assignment has been completed without much care and there are too many mistakes.

2 = The assignment is OK but there are still things to improve.

3 = The assignment is well-done with either no or minimal mistakes.

Final paper

There will be an 8-page long analysis paper.

Model Compositions

You must turn in an original piece at the end of each unit using the theory we covered in class. The pieces do not need to be long, At least 24 measures long. You are going to do a short presentation and then play the piece. You also need to submit a full analysis of your own composition as well. You will have 15 minutes, to present and play.

Presentations

We will have three sessions where we'll discuss a piece. Everybody will prepare and present an analysis paper. A sign-up sheet for the presentations will be distributed on the class.

FZ Policy

Students whose scores add up to less than 30 points (out of 81) by May 1st automatically earn an FZ.

Additionally, you receive an FZ again if your absences exceed 15 hours.

Attendance/Class Participation

Class participation is mandatory. This is not a general core class but a specialty class, so you are expected to attend every meeting except for emergencies. I can tolerate up to 6-hours of absence without any grade drop. If your absences pass beyond this limit, your attendance grade will be affected, as cited in the table below. Please also try to be prompt; late arrivals (after the first 15 minutes) will count as a 1-hour absence. After a total of 16 hours of absence, you will receive a letter grade of FZ.

I also expect you to come to class prepared with the material in hand. This will directly affect your participation grade.

1 absence (2 hours)	15 points
2 absences (4 hours)	15 points
3 absences (6 hours)	15 points
4 absences (8 hours)	14 points
5 absences (10 hours)	12 points

6 absences (12 hours)	9 points
7 absences (14 hours)	5 points
8 absences (16 hours)	0 points
9 absences (18 hours)	FZ

If you miss one of the quizzes, homework or composition performances, you need to submit a valid doctor's notice. Otherwise, you will receive 0 on these assignments.

Participation

Assigned readings are not optional in this class. You are expected to read them before coming to class. For the analysis meetings, you need to do the reading and analyze the piece either by annotating the score and/or by taking notes. If you come to class without preparation or reading the required text, expect a one drop in your participation/attendance daily grade. You must also bring the music to be covered in class. You may download the pieces through the schedule links or the bulk links below.

[Unit 1 - Package](#)

[Unit 2 - Package](#)

[Unit 3 - Package](#)

Academic Integrity

Preamble. Bilkent University is committed to fundamental values necessary to research, academic excellence, the pursuit of learning, and a culture of integrity. These include honesty, trust, fairness, respect, and responsibility among all members of the University community. Faculty, instructors, staff, and students are all strongly encouraged to embrace these values in pursuit of these shared goals.

Academic Dishonesty. In light of its commitment to academic integrity, Bilkent University prohibits acts of misconduct and academic dishonesty. These include, but are not limited to, acts of cheating, plagiarism, and falsification of data, as defined below.

- Cheating occurs when an individual uses dishonesty or deception to receive or help others receive professional or academic credit for work she or he did not perform. Cheating includes, among other acts, misappropriation and / or development of the ideas, concepts, designs, or methodology of others without consent; use of materials or devices not permitted by the instructor during exams; taking an exam for another person; resubmitting work previously submitted elsewhere; copying previously published solutions to problems.
- Plagiarism is representing the work or ideas of another person as one's own. It frequently involves quoting, cutting / pasting or closely paraphrasing written language without appropriately citing the source of the material through the use of quotation marks, reference notes, or other methods of acknowledgement. An act of plagiarism may be unintentional, and to avoid unintentional plagiarism standard practices of citation should be followed. For detailed instructions regarding standard citation practices, see <http://www.plagiarism.org>.
- Falsification is a deliberate misrepresentation in which information, whether in the form of data, written language, images or other media, is either altered or fabricated.

SOURCE: <https://w3.bilkent.edu.tr/bilkent/policy-on-conflicts-of-interest-and-commitment-academic-integrity/>

WEEKLY SCHEDULE

PRELUDE: TWILIGHT OF TONALITY

Mon. 27 January: Prelude (1.1)

Review of chromatic harmony, median relations, augmented 6th chords etc..

Thu. 30 January: Prelude (1.2)

Chopin, Prelude Op. 28 Nos. 2 and 4 [→link](#)

Liszt, Nuages Gris [→link](#)

Wolf, Italienisches Liederbuch Nos. XI and XIII [→link](#)

Wagner, Tristan Prelude [→link](#)

Mon. 3 February: Emancipation of Dissonance (2.1)

Reading: Taruskin, Music in the Early 20th Century ([6-4](#), [6-5](#), [6-6](#))

Analysis: Berg Op. 2 no. 2 "Schlafend tragt man mich" [→link](#)

Schoenberg, Der Wanderer, Op. 6 No. 8 [→link](#)

UNIT 1: SET THEORY

Thu. 6 February: Set Theory 1: Basic Concepts and Definitions (2.2)

Reading: Read Straus ch. 1

Introduction to Set theory. Go over chapter one in class.

Analysis: Webern Op. 11/iii [→link](#)

Webern, "Wie bin ich froh!" from *Three Songs, Op. 25* [→link](#)

Schoenberg, "Nacht," from *Pierrot Lunaire, Op. 21* [→link](#)

Mon. 10 February: Set Theory 2: Basic Concepts and Definitions cont. (3.1)

Readings: Straus ch. 2 - Model Analyses

Analysis: Schoenberg, No. 11 from *Book of the Hanging Gardens* [→link](#)

Bartók, *String Quartet No. 4*, first movement [→link](#)

Assignment: Homework No.1 is due [→link](#)

Thu. 13 February: Set Theory 3: Pitch-class sets cont. (3.2)

Readings: Straus ch. 3

Assignment: Homework No.2 is due [→link](#)

Analysis: Webern *Op. 5 no 4* [→link](#)

Bartok, *String Quartet No.4, III*

Mon. 17 February: Set Theory 4: Some additional properties and relationships (4.1)

Reading: Straus, ch. 4

Assignment: Homework No.3 is due [→link](#)

Analysis: Webern *Op.11 No.1* [→link](#)

Thu. 20 February: Discussion Session — Schoenberg Op. 11 no. 1 (4.2)

Readings: Wittlich (1974) p. 41-46 [→link](#),

Ogdon (1981), p. 169-82 [→link](#),

Analysis: Forte (1981), p. 127-151 →[link](#)
Schoenberg op. 11/i →[link](#)
Assignment: *Homework No.4 is due* →[link](#)

Mon. 24 February: Model Compositions (5.1)

Model Composition no. 1 is due.
Be prepared to play it in the class.
Analysis: Elliott Carter, *Gra* →[link](#)

UNIT 2: TWELVE-TONE TOPICS

Thu. 27 February: Basic Twelve-Tone Operations (5.2)

Reading: Read Straus ch. 6. and 6.2
Analysis: Schoenberg, Op. 25, Gavotte, →[link](#) Dallapiccolo, “*Quaderno musicale di Annalibera*” no. 5 and 11 →[link2](#), →[link3](#)

Mon. 3 March: Webern and Invariance (6.1)

Reading: Read Straus 6, pages 179-183 “Webern and Derivation” and Whithall
“Anton Webern: Discipline and License” →[link](#)
Analysis: Webern, *Op. 24 and op. 28* →[link1](#), →[link2](#)
Assignment: *Homework No.5 is due* →[link](#)

Thu. 6 March: Basic Schoenberg and hexachordal combinatoriality I (6.2)

Reading: Straus ch. 6, pages, 184-192 & 210-214
Analysis: Schoenberg, *op. 33a* →[link](#)
Schoenberg, *op. 45* →[link](#)
Schoenberg, *String Quartet No.4*
Assignment: *Homework No.6 is due* →[link](#)

Mon. 10 March: No Class Spring Break

Thu. 13 March: Berg, Tonality and Series (7.1)

Reading: Whithall, “Alban Berg: Reverence and Resistance” →[link](#)
Analysis: Berg, *Lyric Suite, I* →[link](#)
Assignment: *Homework No.7 is due* →[link](#)

Mon. 17 March: Stravinsky and rotational array (7.2)

Readings: Straus ch. 6, pages, 193-96, Straus, Stravinsky’s Late Music
Analysis: Stravinsky “*Requiem Canticles*” Lacrimosa →[link](#) and *Agon* - Second
pas de trois: Trois: Bransle Simple and Bransle Gay →[link](#)
Boulez - *Dérive* →[link1](#)
Assignment: Chapter 6 Exercise no: VI and VII page 340-341 →[link](#)

Thu. 20 March: Webern and Invariance II - Presentations (8.1)

Introduction to Post-war serialism
Assignment: Webern “*Symphony*” *Op. 21*

Reading: Bailey (1983) → [link](#),
Goldthwaite (1969) → [link](#),
Nelson (1969) → [link](#)
Analysis: Webern “*Symphony*” *op. 21* → [link](#)
Messiaen *Mode de Valeurs et d'Intensités* → [link](#)
Assignment: *Homework No.8 is due* → [link](#)

Mon. 24 March: Midterm Exam (8.2)

Thu. 27 March: Post War Serialism I (9.1)

Readings: Bailey, Work in Progress Analysis of *Il Canto Sospeso* → [link](#)
Harvey, Stockhausen Chapter 7 → [link](#)
Analysis: Nono, *Il Canto Sospeso* → [link](#)
Stockhausen, *Kreuzspiel* → [link](#)
Berio *Points on a Curve* → [link](#)

Mon. 31 March: Holiday No classes

Thu. 4 Apr: Post Serialism II and Model Compositions (9.2)

Model Composition no. 2 is due.

Be prepared to play it in the class.

Readings: Toop, Brian Ferneyhough's *Lemma-Icon-Epigram* → [link](#)
Analysis: Ferneyhough, **Lemma-Icon-Epigraph** → [link](#)
Ferneyhough, **Superscriptio** → [link](#)
Ligeti, *Trio for Horn*, Piano and Violin → [link](#)
Isang Yun, *Könglisches Thema* → [link](#)

UNIT 3: CENTRICITY AND REFERENTIAL COLLECTIONS

Mon 7 April: Tonality, Centricity, Diatonic Collection (10.1)

Reading: Straus Ch. 4, p.112-119; Roig-Francoli, Ch. 1, p. 5-36
Analysis: Debussy, “*La Cathedrale Engloutie*” → [link](#) Stravinsky, “*Agon*” Pas de
Quatre → [link](#)

Thu. 10 April: Modality (10.2)

Analysis: Satie, *Gnossienne 1* → [link](#)
Ravel: *Piano Trio* → [link](#)
Adams, *China Gates* → [link](#)

Mon. 14 April: Octatonic and Whole Tone (11.1)

Reading: Straus ch. 4, p. 120-132; Roig-Francoli, Ch. 2
Analysis: Scriabin *Op. 74 Preludes* → [link](#)
Debussy “*Voiles*” → [link](#)
Debussy “*Le Jeu*” → [link](#) Piano reduction → [link](#)

Thu. 17 April: Le Sacre du Printemps and Bartok Fourth String Quartet (11.2)

Assignment: Homework No.9 is due [→link](#)

Readings: Arthur Berger “Problems of Pitch Organization in Stravinsky” [→link](#)
Ricard Taruskin “Russian Folk Melodies in "The Rite of Spring" [→link](#)
Van den Toorn “Stravinsky and the Octatonic- The Sounds of Stravinsky”

[→link](#)

Dimitri Tymoczko “Stravinsky and the Octatonic- A Reconsideration”

[→link](#)

Pierre Boulez “ Stravinsky Remains”

Mon. 21 April: No class

Thu. 24 April: Model Compositions and Debussy’ Les Jeux(12.1)

Analysis: TBA

EPILOGUE: POST-SERIALISM

Mon. 28 April: Ligeti and Mass compositions(12.2)

Analysis: TBA

Thu. 1 May: Holiday, No Class

Mon. 5 May: Spectralism I (13.1)

Reading: Rose [→link](#)

Fineberg: Guide to Basic Concepts and Techniques [→link](#)

Analysis: Grisey: Partiels [→link](#)

Murail: [→link](#)

Thu. 8 May: Spectralism II (13.2)

Assignment: Homework No.9 is due

Analysis: Ligeti: Hamburg Concerto [→link](#)

Chin: Etudes No.1 “In C” [→link](#)

Haas: In Vain [→link](#)

Mon. 12 May: Beat Furrer (14.1)

May 19 and 20: Individual meetings for final paper, analysis first draft due (14.2)

Wed. May 28th, 23:59

Final Paper is due

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